

Week 08

[← Back to Home](#)

Documentation

Progress Reports

I wasn't able to attend the progress report session, so I did not present my slideshow or receive direct feedback from peers during the discussion. Because of this, I reflected on earlier conversations, previous critiques, and my own development process to evaluate where the project currently stands.

If I had presented, my project would have focused on visualising phone use and emotions through a colour-based timeline. My main feedback questions would have been whether the emotional colour system was clear, whether the timeline structure made sense, and whether the project communicated emotional patterns effectively.

Although I missed the session, reflecting on my own work helped me realise that the strongest part of the project is not the phone usage data itself, but the emotional patterns connected to behaviour. This reinforced my decision to keep the project simple and focused on emotional readability rather than adding unnecessary complexity.

Critical Design Propostions

For the critical design proposition activity, I reflected on how another data-driven project could be expanded beyond simply displaying information. The most interesting aspect of data-based projects is their ability to make invisible behaviours visible, but sometimes the emotional or experiential side feels less developed.

If I were proposing an alternative direction, I would suggest moving from a purely informational format toward something more interactive or experiential. Instead of only displaying data through charts or static visuals, the project could allow people to experience patterns through movement, interaction, or changing visual environments.

For example, data could become something users move through rather than simply observe. Colours, animation, or interactive elements could create stronger emotional connections and make

patterns feel more personal.

This exercise made me reflect on my own project because I realised that I also want to balance clarity with emotional experience rather than focusing only on displaying information.

What this changes

- From: Data shown as information
- To: Data experienced emotionally
- From: Static viewing
- To: Interactive exploration

This also connects back to your phone-use project because your goal is not only to show behaviour, but to help people recognise emotional patterns in a more meaningful way.

Independent Study

Reflective Summary

I wasn't able to attend the progress report session, so I didn't get direct feedback on my presentation. Because of this, I spent time reflecting on my earlier ideas, peer conversations, and how my project has been developing so far.

What became clear is that the most important part of my project is the emotional connection to phone use, rather than just the usage data itself. My project explores how emotions like stress, tiredness, happiness, and boredom influence the way people interact with their phones, and how these patterns build up over time. This emotional layer is what gives the project meaning and makes it more relatable.

Another key insight was around complexity. Earlier versions of my idea included layered emotions and more complicated systems, but I realised this made the concept harder to read and understand. Because of that, I've decided to simplify the design so the information is clearer and more accessible.

Looking back at earlier feedback and my own development, I also realised that the project is less about accurately measuring behaviour and more about encouraging reflection. It is about helping people notice patterns in their everyday habits that they might normally overlook.

Moving forward, I want to focus on developing a simple timeline system where each phone-use moment is linked to one clear emotion. This will help keep the design easy to understand while still showing meaningful emotional patterns over time.

Project Development

I built and tested small datasets using phone usage logs combined with emotional labels. Instead of combining multiple emotions in a single session, I assigned one main emotion to each period of phone use.

I also tested a simplified colour system to see how clearly different emotions could be recognised at a glance. This helped me understand how visual clarity improves when the system is kept simple.

What I learned

- Simple systems make patterns easier to see
- Too many categories reduce clarity
- Colour is an effective way to communicate emotion quickly
- A well-structured dataset is essential before designing visuals

Skills Developed

- Structuring time-based datasets
- Defining consistent emotional categories
- Using colour to represent meaning
- Testing simple visual layouts for clarity

How this moved my project forward

This stage helped me refine my idea into something more focused and achievable. Instead of trying to build a complex system, I now understand that my project is stronger when it clearly shows emotional patterns in a simple and readable way. This gives me a clearer direction for developing my final visual outcome.